

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

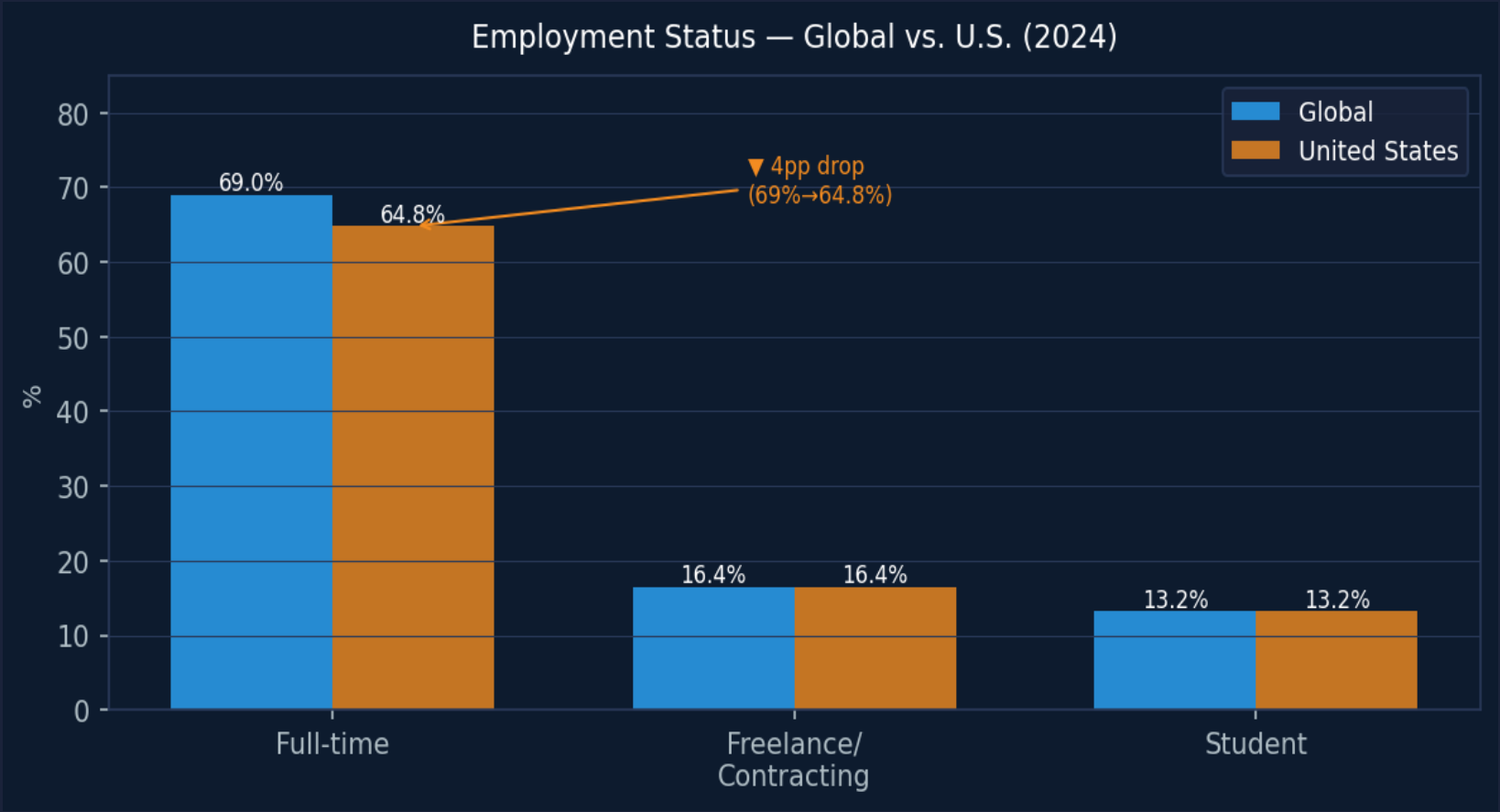
2024 Stack Overflow Developer Survey

65,437 respondents · 180+ countries

Benchmarking guide for Engineering Managers & HR Leaders

84% of Developers Are Working — But Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

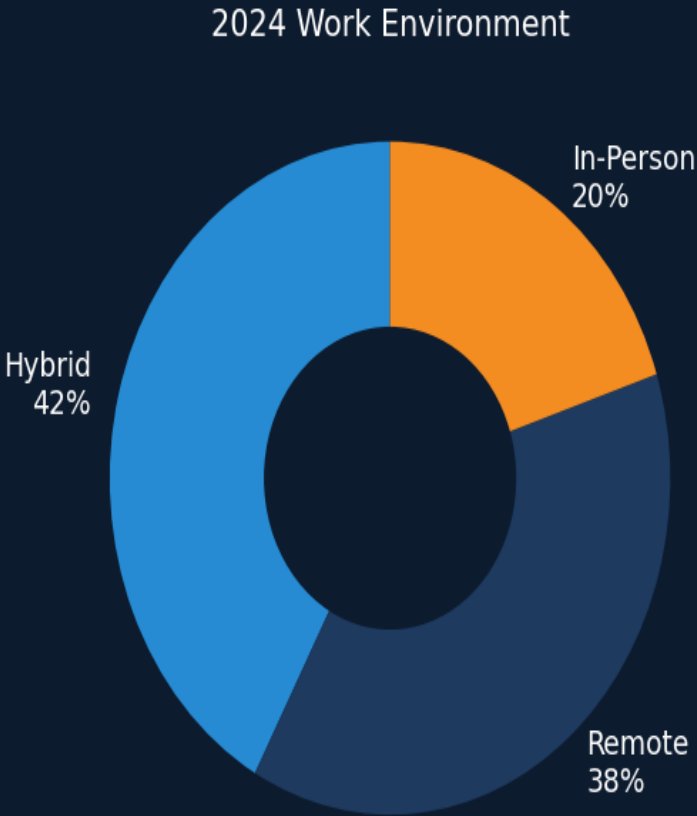
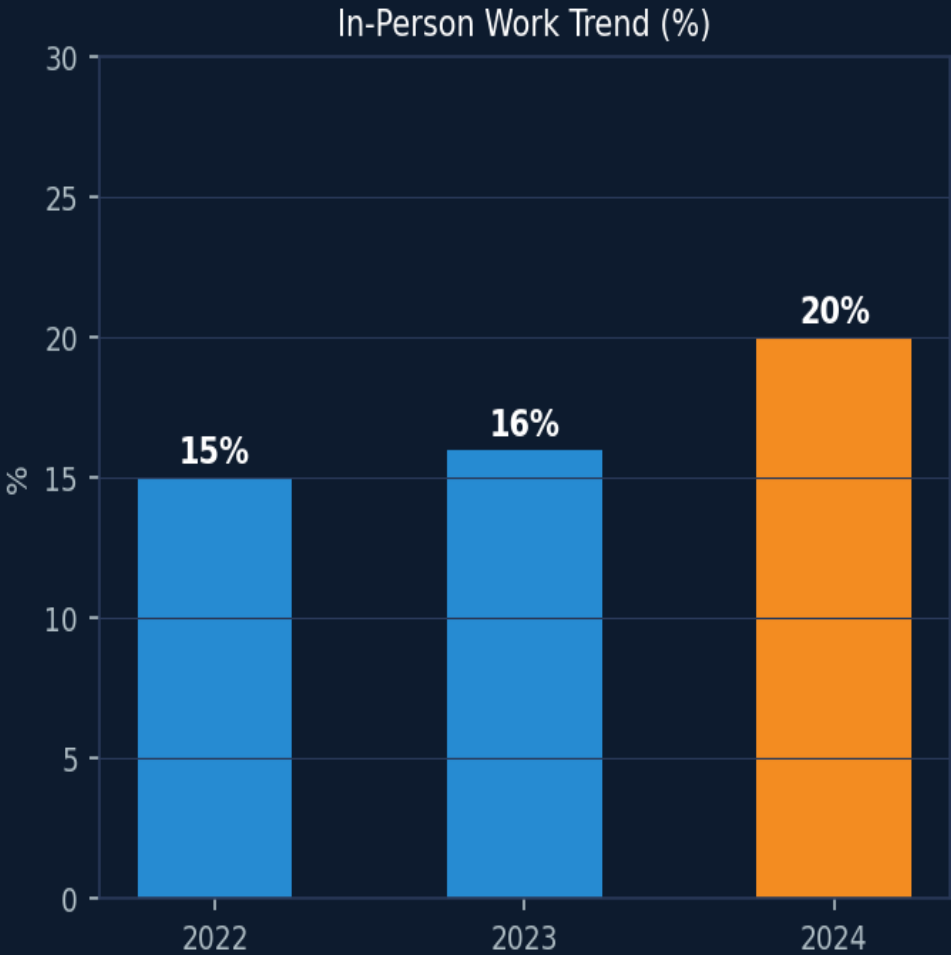
Employment status, 65,437 respondents | 2024 Stack Overflow Survey



84%	currently employed
69%	global full-time
64.8%	U.S. full-time (↓4pp)
16.4%	freelance / contract
13.2%	full-time students

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Work-environment trends 2022–2024 | 2024 Stack Overflow Survey



Hybrid

42% — most common, unchanged from 2023

Remote

38% — second most common

In-Person

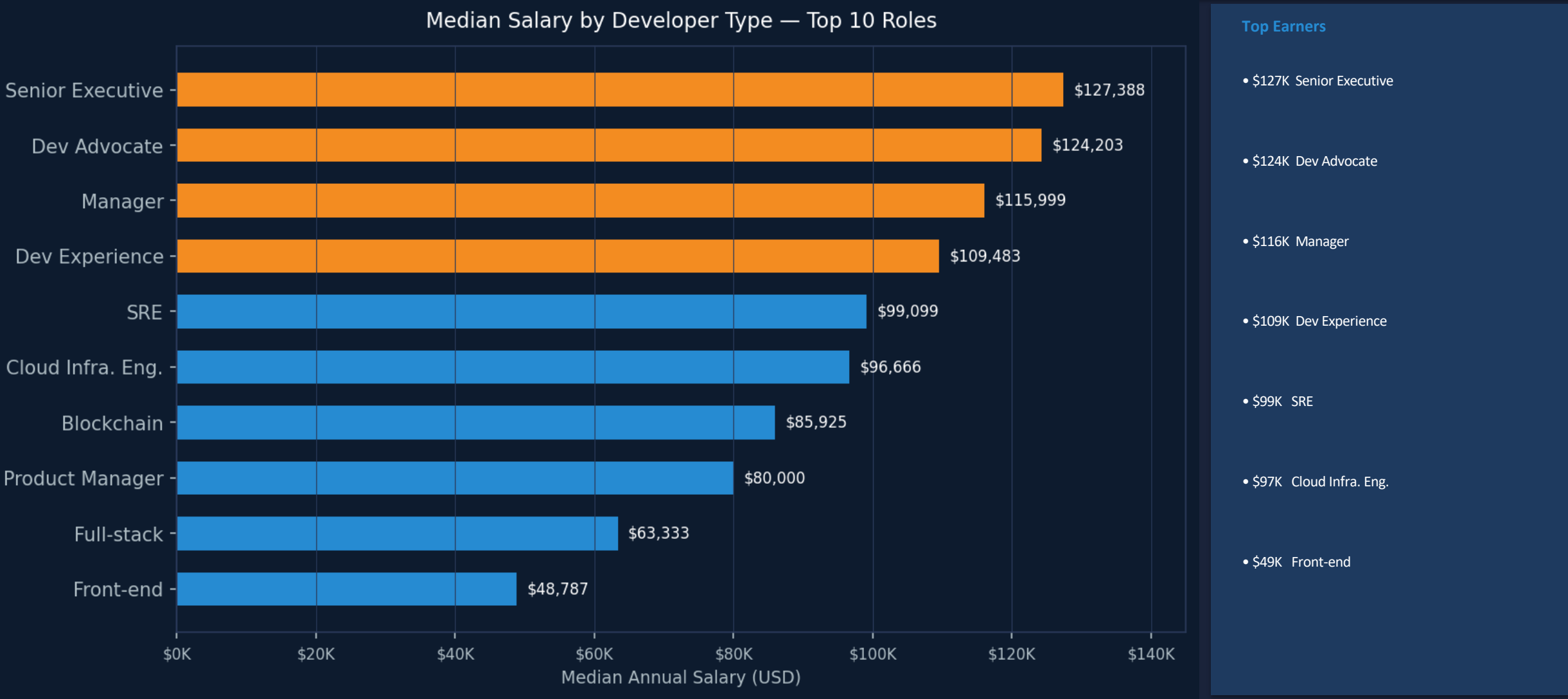
20% — 3rd consecutive year of growth

RTO signal

Up from 15% in 2022 to 20% in 2024

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

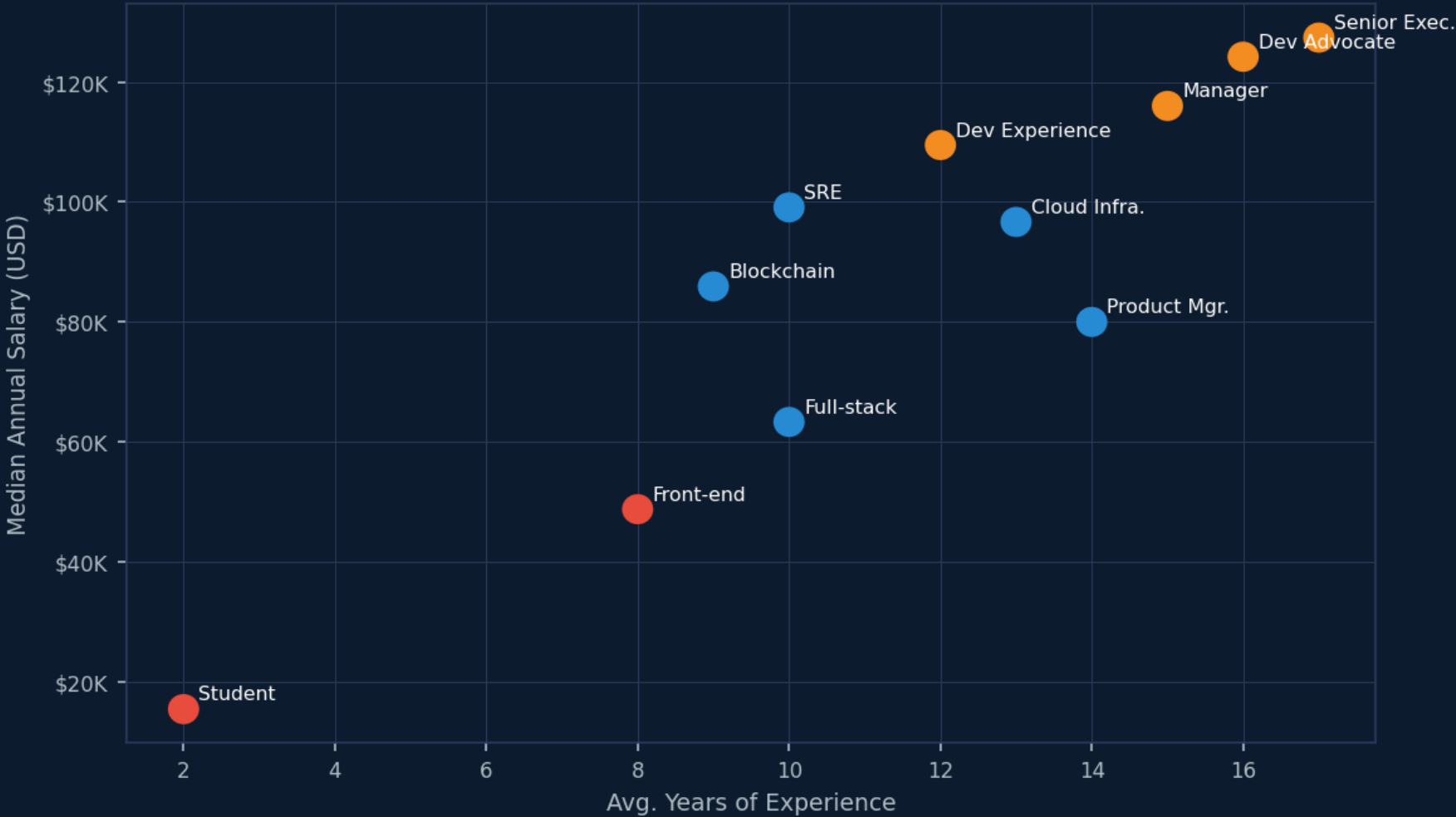
Median annual compensation (USD) | 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate)



Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. avg. years of experience by role | 2024 Stack Overflow Survey

Experience vs. Salary by Developer Type

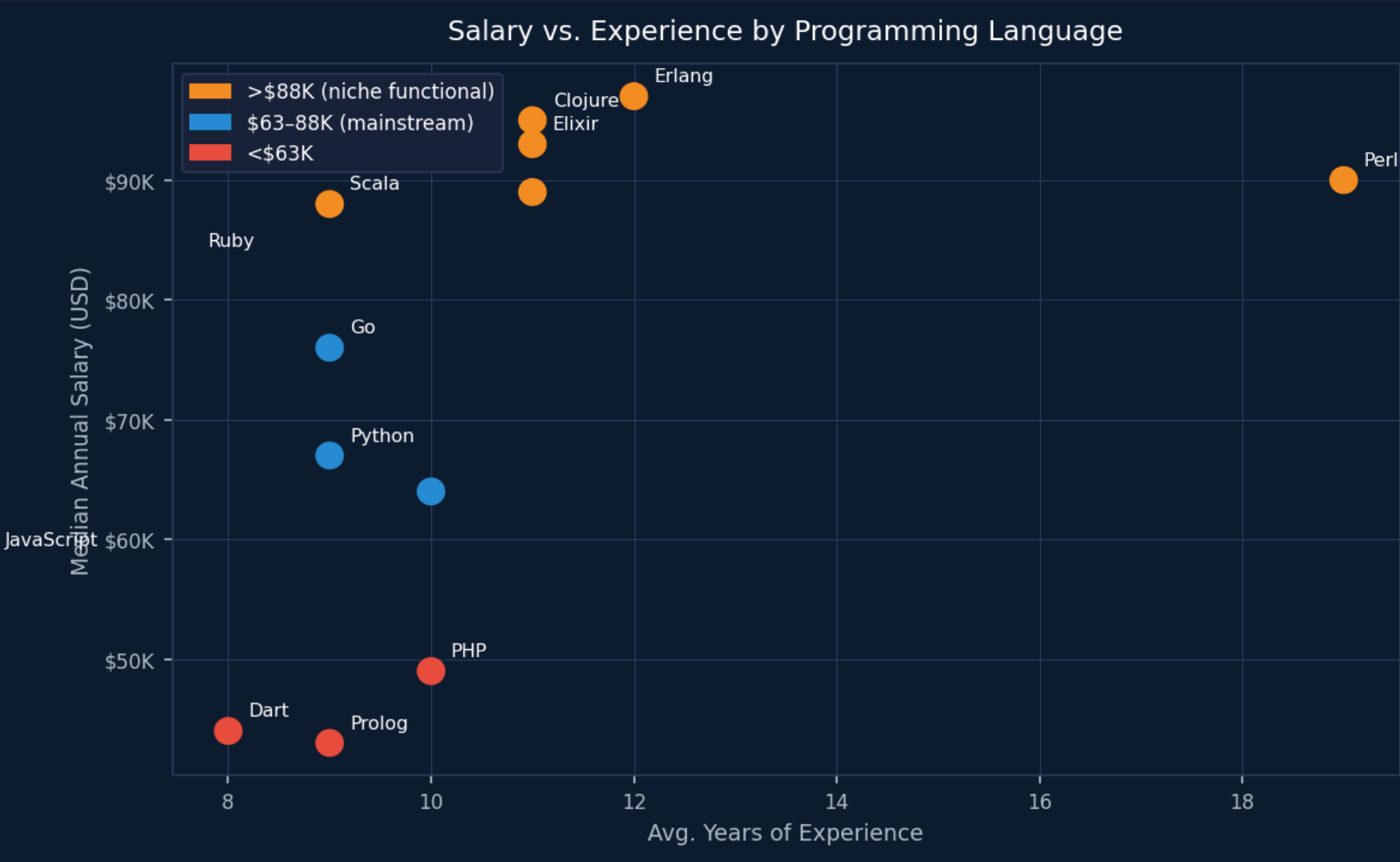


Key Observations

- Senior Exec., Dev Advocate, & Manager cluster upper-right (15–17 yrs, \$116K+)
- SRE & Cloud Infra highest-paid pure technical roles (~\$97–99K)
- Student is clear outlier (\$15K, ~2 yrs exp.)
- Front-end earns \$49K despite 8 yrs exp.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. avg. years experience by language | overall range ↓\$10K vs. 2023



Notable Languages

Top earners

Erlang \$97K, Clojure \$95K, Elixir \$93K

Mid tier

Go \$76K, Python \$67K, JS \$64K

Lowest

Dart \$44K, Prolog \$43K, PHP \$49K

YoY trend

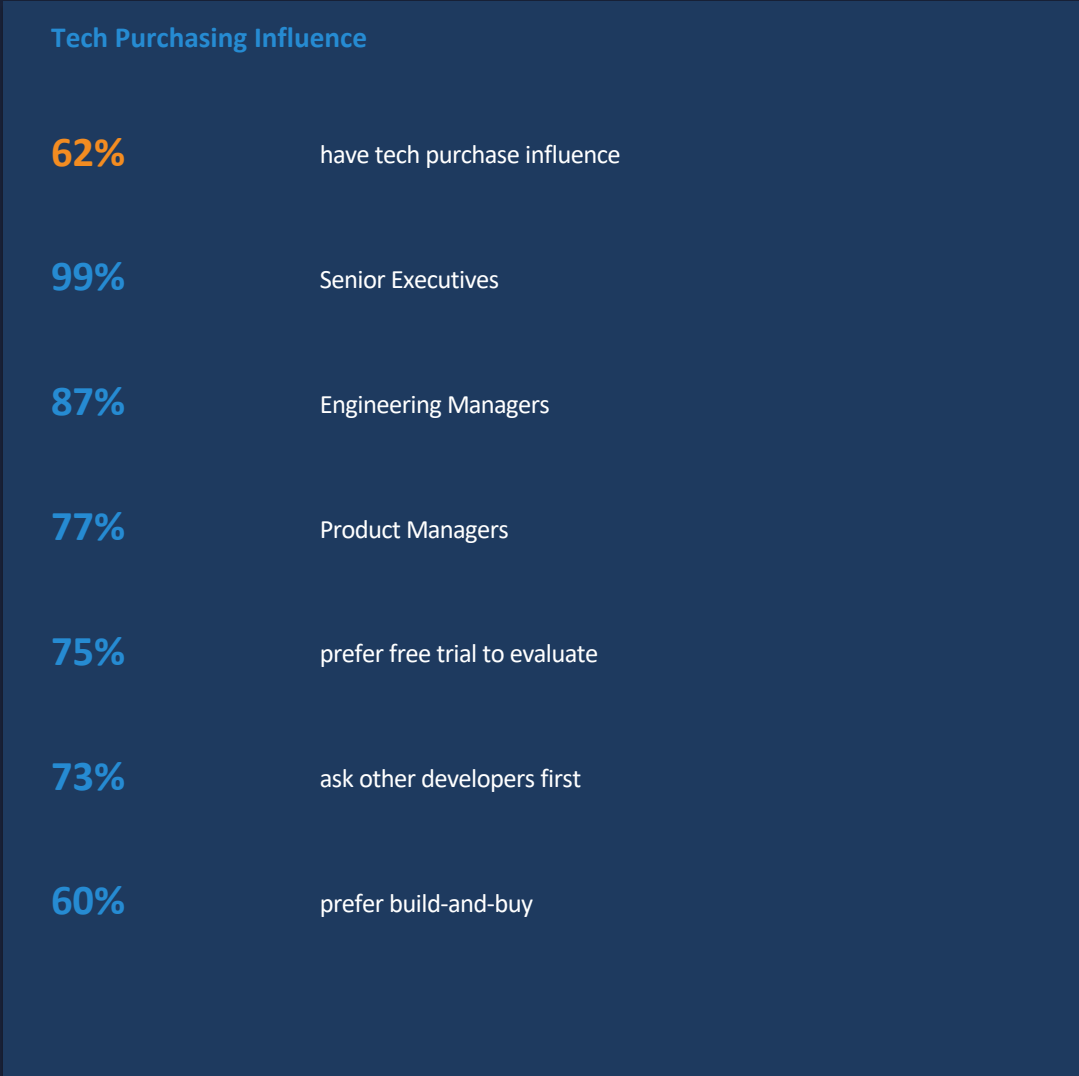
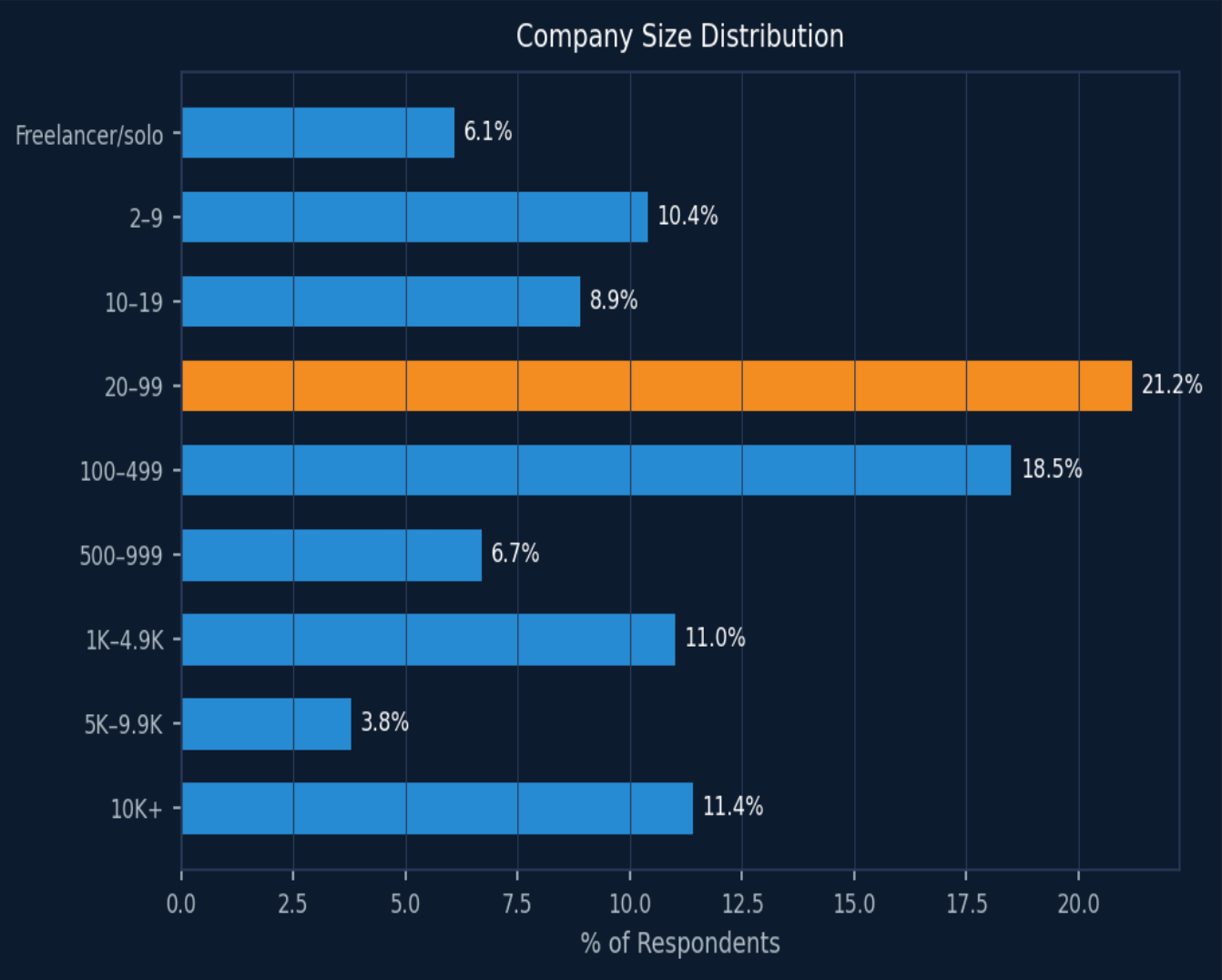
Avg. range ↓\$10K vs. 2023 (\$60–75K now vs. \$70–85K)

Pattern

Niche functional languages → premium pay

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company size distribution & technology purchasing influence | 2024 Stack Overflow Survey



Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable insights for engineering leaders and HR — 2024 Stack Overflow Survey

01	Plan for More Contractors U.S. full-time employment fell 4pp to 64.8%. Freelancing/contracting at 16.4% globally. Build flexible workforce models that blend FTE and contract talent.
02	Hybrid Is the Default — But RTO Is Growing 42% hybrid, 20% in-person (up from 15% in 2022). In-person mandates risk talent loss; offer structured hybrid as baseline.
03	Premium Roles Require Premium Comp DevRel (\$124K), SRE (\$99K), and Cloud Infra (\$97K) command market rates. Underpaying these roles drives attrition to competitors.
04	Language Matters for Salary Benchmarks Erlang/Clojure/Elixir devs earn >\$93K. When benchmarking, filter by language stack — JS/PHP engineers earn 30–50% less than functional language peers.
05	Engage Developers Directly in Vendor Decisions 62% of devs influence purchases; free trials (75%) and peer recommendations (73%) drive evaluation. Empower your engineers in the buying process.